MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps & Platform Engineering

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams, provides review environments to QA and product teams, and authored CI documentation used for onboarding; has improved delivery speed and test reliability through CI/CD optimisation, dependency caching, ephemeral test environments and automation. Hands-on with Docker, Helm and namespace-level Kubernetes deployments for ephemeral test environments, plus personal experience building a k3s homelab and provisioning Hetzner VPS infrastructure with Terraform. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and containers: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm

Infrastructure as code and orchestration: Terraform (personal Hetzner project), Kubernetes (namespace-level professional work; personal k3s homelab), Argo CD, Ansible (basic)

Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL

Languages and testing: Python, Bash, Java (test code), pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Other: Linux, Git

Cloud: AWS (personal learning: EC2 and S3 basics), Hetzner VPS (personal Terraform project).

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by approximately 30%.
- Built and maintain merge-request ephemeral environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster; each environment includes the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, supports QA and product review, and is automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and used CI results to build Grafana dashboards for flaky tests.
- Wrote internal documentation explaining the CI system; the documentation is used for team onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, and configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS in the personal k3s homelab.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived review environments deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster, with end-to-end tests running against each environment.
- Automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky test rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level *2019*

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) *Studying; exam scheduled for January 2027*

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)